

fullest. For example, despite holding the Commonwealth Games, Delhi has failed to use the opportunity to make the city cleaner and more beautiful. We hope that the spark that INDIA TODAY has ignited catches up for the growth of India.

A.J. SAHAYAM,
via www.indiatoday.in

Special Gift

The Rajpal Khullar Memorial Trust needs to be thanked for setting up the Akshar School ("A Regular Miracle", September 28). It is indeed unique that the school conceived the system wherein special children get to study in a mainstream school along with regular children. There is a strong opinion that special children should be sent to separate schools because they need special treatment. Amid these notions, Akshar's programme is really the most appropriate way to encourage such differentlyabled children.

PREM K. MENON,
via www.indiatoday.in

Learning Theory

One couldn't agree more with Kaveree Bamzai's call for a revival of the NCC and NSS at schools ("Restore, Not Remove", September 28). The need of the hour is to try and bring back some discipline and values that Indian culture once stood for. This,

of course, is unrelated to the question of scrapping the CBSE Class X exams, a move that is not likely to change the country's deteriorating educational system.

M.H. RAO, *Hyderabad*

Kid Stuff

Parents should try and think the way the child does to try to understand him or her better ("Helicopter Parents", September 21). This would, in



“The politics of encounter has a direct bearing on our fight against terror and must not be compromised for petty party and votebank politics as reflected in the Ishrat Jahan case.”

B. SAHAI, via www.indiatoday.in

turn, give them the opportunity to guide them better rather than imposing their worldview on them.

ARYA CHAKRABORTI, *Chennai*

It is true that parents are duty-bound in nurturing children to attain great heights. But overenthusiasm often turns counter-productive. Given

reasonable space to move on their own, kids will be able to build a bright future for themselves. The article indeed offers valuable perspectives on effective parenting.

K.S. THAMPI,
Chennai

A New Chapter

The article on the study of genes made for an interesting reading ("The Great Indian Gene Findings", September 21). Scientists

and anthropologists may have different takes on the issue. The Government, however, must initiate measures to extend the geographical information system for an online disease surveillance and ensure longevity, especially in the rural areas.

MEENAMBIKAI S.,
via www.indiatoday.in

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

DECEMBER 1-15, 1979

The Caste War

On February 23, 1962, a week before the country's third general election, large advertisements appeared in national dailies propagating the cause of the Congress party. "An appeal to national patriots"; announced the slogan in *The Hindustan Times*, "A vote for Panditji is a vote for stability and progress." That was Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru's last election—he died in May 1964—but weeks before the country went once again to the polls 15 years later, in March 1977, his daughter appeared on millions of dramatic posters plastered on city streets and village walls. The famous slogan that ran along with was: "She stands between stability and chaos." Today once again, with feeling, her Congress party reiterates her old stand. *Indira Lao, Desh Bachao* (Bring Indira—Save the Nation) scream the slogans. Belatedly, she promises stability in the face of disorder. The Janata Party goes further: it promises bread with liberty.

by Sunil Sethi, Arul B. Louis and
Prabhu Chawla

GANDHI WITH OTHER LEADERS



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